

PREFACE

We live on a planet that is covered in amazing features, ranging from the red sands of the Sahara Desert to the blue ice of glaciers such as Vatnajökull, and from the grandeur of mountain chains like the Himalayas to the simple beauty of a bluebell wood. You might think that your list of things to see and do is complete, but once you start to look through the pages of this book you will realize there is so much more to discover and be inspired to go travelling once again.

However, you don't have to leave the comforts of home to enjoy the wonders of our world. Through this book you can see Earth's most active and dangerous volcanoes without taking any risks. If you don't

have a head for heights but want to know what the view from the top of Angel Falls looks like, then turn to the entry on South America's Guiana Highlands. Even if you can't swim, you'll be able to find out what it would be like to dive inside the Great Blue Hole off the coast of Belize. And if you don't have time to trek through the Congo, you can still marvel at the wildlife in its rainforest. This book will also take you to places where access is severely limited—only a few people each year are given permission to explore the Hang Son Doong cave system in Vietnam but you will see what it is like to stand in its vast interior.

